

△CS Layer 2

Cross-Discipline Coherence Layer (CDCL)

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 Document Scope Notice

This document constitutes the authoritative operating charter for the Cross-Discipline Coherence Layer (CDCL) of the Triangulated Coherent Systems (△CS) governance framework. It is binding upon all participating disciplines, their designated liaisons, and all governance bodies operating within or interfacing with the △CS stack. Supersedes all prior draft coherence protocols.

SECTION 1 — LAYER IDENTITY

Attribute	Value
Layer Designation	Cross-Discipline Coherence Layer (CDCL)
Altitude	Layer 2
Function	Maintains the structural, definitional, and conceptual coherence across all participating disciplines within the △CS framework.
Position in △CS Stack	Sits above the Governance-Discipline

Attribute	Value
	Interface Layer (Layer 1); below the Cross-Discipline Synchronization Layer (Layer 3).
Primary Instrument Authority	Chief Coherence Officer (CCO)
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1.1 △CS Layer Stack — Positional Reference

The table below illustrates the position of Layer 2 within the full △CS governance stack for orientation purposes. The active layer is highlighted.

Layer	Designation	Relative Position
Layer 7	Governance-Level Invitation/Exclusion Layer	Above
Layer 6	Governance-Level Evaluation Layer	Above
Layer 4 – 5	Upper Governance Layers (reserved)	Above
Layer 3	Cross-Discipline Synchronization Layer	Immediately Above
Layer 2 ◀	Cross-Discipline Coherence Layer (CDCL) — THIS DOCUMENT	Current Layer
Layer 1	Governance-Discipline Interface Layer (GDIL)	Immediately Below

SECTION 2 — PURPOSE AND SCOPE

2.1 Purpose

The Cross-Discipline Coherence Layer (CDCL) is the architecture of shared meaning within the △CS framework. It exists to ensure that all disciplines operating under △CS governance maintain structural, definitional, and conceptual alignment — not merely procedural compliance — with one another and with the framework as a whole.

Without coherence, disciplines may pursue internally valid bodies of work that are mutually contradictory, definitionally incompatible, or structurally incoherent when placed in contact with one another. The CDCL prevents this failure mode not by constraining disciplinary inquiry, but by establishing and enforcing the shared conceptual conditions under which multi-discipline work remains coherent and governable.

⚠ **Governing Rationale**

Coherence is not a stylistic preference. Conceptual drift between disciplines is a structural risk to the integrity of Δ CS governance outputs and joint deliverables. The CDCL treats it accordingly.

2.2 Scope

The CDCL governs the following categories of shared intellectual infrastructure:

- **Conceptual Frameworks:** All analytical or theoretical frameworks deployed across two or more Δ CS disciplines simultaneously.
- **Definitional Standards:** All terms, constructs, and concepts appearing in cross-discipline communications, joint deliverables, governance submissions, or shared operating documents.
- **Foundational Assumptions:** All explicit and implicit assumptions that underpin the methodological or interpretive posture of a discipline when it operates in shared domain with another.

The CDCL does not govern discipline-internal terminology, frameworks, or assumptions where those have no operative contact with another discipline's work or Δ CS shared outputs.

SECTION 3 — CORE FUNCTIONS

The CDCL exercises four core functions. Each is described below with its operative mechanisms and key instruments.

3.1 Definitional Standardization

The CDCL establishes and maintains the **△CS Master Lexicon (AML)** — the authoritative, version-controlled register of all shared terms, concepts, and constructs operative across two or more △CS disciplines. The Master Lexicon is a living document, updated on a rolling basis in accordance with the amendment conditions specified in Section 11.

Where definitional conflicts arise between disciplines — whether in the meaning, scope, or application of a shared term — the CDCL resolves those conflicts through the **Coherence Adjudication Protocol** (Section 6). No discipline may unilaterally redefine a term registered in the Master Lexicon without triggering a formal coherence review.

3.2 Framework Alignment

The CDCL reviews conceptual and analytical frameworks deployed across disciplines for structural compatibility. Review may be initiated:

- Proactively, during the planning phase of any major cross-discipline initiative;
- Reactively, upon receipt of a Coherence Dispute Notice (CDN) from a participating discipline; or
- Systematically, as part of the periodic Coherence Audit cycle.

Where frameworks are found to diverge at load-bearing structural points, the CDCL issues a **Coherence Advisory** through the Coherence Advisory System (CAS). The appropriate tier of advisory (Advisory, Warning, or Critical) is assigned in accordance with the severity of the divergence and its potential impact on shared outputs.

3.3 Assumption Mapping

The CDCL maintains the **Cross-Discipline Assumption Register (CDAR)** — a structured, continuously updated inventory of the foundational assumptions held by each discipline, organized by discipline, domain, and risk tier. The purpose of the CDAR is to surface hidden assumption conflicts before they propagate into joint deliverables or governance decisions.

Disciplines are required to submit assumption declarations upon joining any shared initiative. Discipline Coherence Liaisons (Section 9) are responsible for maintaining the accuracy of their discipline's entries in the CDAR.

3.4 Coherence Audit

The CDCL conducts periodic coherence audits of all cross-discipline outputs and shared governance materials. Each audit cycle produces a **Coherence Audit Report (CAR)**, which is submitted to governance deliberative bodies and forwarded to the Cross-Discipline Synchronization Layer (Layer 3) for cross-cycle continuity tracking.

The CAR documents all coherence deviations identified during the cycle, the advisories issued, the rulings made, and any open disputes or unresolved tensions carried forward. It serves as the primary accountability instrument of the CDCL.

SECTION 4 — STRUCTURAL COMPONENTS

The CDCL operates through four primary structural instruments, each described in the table below.

Component	Acronym	Description and Function
△CS Master Lexicon	AML	The living, version-controlled register of all shared terminological and conceptual standards across △CS disciplines. The authoritative source for definitional disputes. Maintained by the CCO; updated on rolling basis per Section 11.
Cross-Discipline Assumption Register	CDAR	Structured inventory mapping all operative foundational assumptions by discipline, domain, and risk tier. Used to detect hidden assumption conflicts prior to joint work. Maintained by Discipline Coherence Liaisons under CCO oversight.
Coherence Advisory System	CAS	A tiered notification system for coherence deviations, with three

Component	Acronym	Description and Function
		severity levels: Advisory (low-risk divergence requiring acknowledgment), Warning (structural divergence requiring corrective action), and Critical (systemic coherence failure requiring immediate intervention and escalation).
Coherence Audit Report	CAR	Periodic output produced each governance audit cycle. Submitted to governance deliberative bodies and the Synchronization Layer (Layer 3). Documents coherence deviations, advisories issued, rulings made, and open disputes. Primary accountability instrument of the CDCL.

4.1 Coherence Advisory System — Tier Definitions

Tier	Trigger Condition	Required Response
Advisory	Minor definitional or framework divergence identified; low risk of propagation to shared outputs.	Acknowledgment by affected Discipline Coherence Liaisons within one governance cycle. No mandatory corrective action unless divergence persists.
Warning	Structural divergence at a load-bearing definitional or framework point; potential to compromise joint deliverable integrity.	Formal response from affected disciplines within one governance cycle. Corrective action plan submitted to CCO within two cycles.
Critical	Systemic coherence failure; divergence affecting three or more disciplines or rendering a	Immediate escalation to CCO. Coherence Panel convened within five business days. Potential

Tier	Trigger Condition	Required Response
	shared output ungovernable.	escalation to Layer 6 or Layer 7 per Section 10.

SECTION 5 — OPERATING PRINCIPLES

The following principles govern all CDCL operations. They are not aspirational; they are operative standards against which CDCL conduct and rulings are evaluated.

1. **Shared Meaning.** Terms used across two or more disciplines must carry equivalent definitional weight in all shared contexts. Disciplines may not assume that internally held definitions transfer automatically to shared domain use without registration in the Δ CS Master Lexicon.
2. **Transparent Divergence.** When disciplines must legitimately diverge in their use of a term, framework, or foundational assumption — whether for methodological necessity or disciplinary reason — that divergence must be explicitly named, bounded in scope, and formally logged in the CDAR. Silent divergence is not permissible under any circumstance.
3. **No Silent Drift.** Conceptual drift between disciplines — the gradual, unacknowledged movement apart in the meaning or application of shared constructs — is treated as a structural risk to the Δ CS framework, not a stylistic or preference-level difference. The CDCL monitors for drift proactively and addresses it through the appropriate CAS tier.
4. **Primacy of Coherence.** In all shared-domain matters, coherence requirements take precedence over disciplinary preference. Where a discipline believes that a coherence requirement unreasonably constrains its legitimate methodological practice, the appropriate remedy is the Coherence Adjudication Protocol (Section 6), not unilateral non-compliance.
5. **Constructive Challenge.** Any discipline may challenge a coherence ruling issued by the CDCL through the formal adjudication protocol. Challenge is a protected and encouraged function of the system. The CDCL is not infallible,

and its rulings must remain open to principled contestation within the established process.

SECTION 6 — COHERENCE ADJUDICATION PROTOCOL

The Coherence Adjudication Protocol (CAP) governs the formal resolution of disputes arising from contested terms, frameworks, or assumptions within the Δ CS shared domain. All parties to a coherence dispute are bound by this protocol and its outcomes.

Initiating Condition

Any discipline operating within Δ CS may initiate the Coherence Adjudication Protocol by filing a Coherence Dispute Notice (CDN). Filing of a CDN does not constitute a finding of fault against any party; it is a formal acknowledgment that a coherence question requires structured resolution.

6.1 Protocol Steps

6. **Filing of Coherence Dispute Notice (CDN).** The initiating discipline files a CDN with the Governance Secretariat, identifying with specificity: (a) the contested term, framework, or assumption; (b) the nature of the dispute; (c) the disciplines involved; and (d) the potential impact on shared outputs or governance decisions. The CDN is submitted on the prescribed CDCL form and logged in the official dispute register.
7. **Convening of Coherence Panel.** Upon receipt of a valid CDN, the CCO convenes a Coherence Panel consisting of not fewer than three representatives: at minimum one neutral party (not a primary stakeholder in the disputed matter) and representatives from each of the two or more directly affected disciplines. The Panel composition is documented and circulated to all disputing parties prior to deliberation.

8. **Panel Deliberation.** The Coherence Panel reviews the CDN, relevant entries in the Δ CS Master Lexicon and CDAR, and any supporting submissions made by the disputing disciplines. Deliberation is conducted according to CDCL procedural rules and must remain confined to the specific coherence question raised. The Panel may request additional submissions from disciplines but may not expand the scope of the dispute without mutual consent of the parties.
9. **Issuance of Coherence Ruling.** The Panel issues a written Coherence Ruling within one full governance cycle of the CDN's formal acceptance. The Ruling sets out: (a) the Panel's finding on the dispute; (b) any required changes to the Δ CS Master Lexicon, CDAR, or framework records; and (c) any Coherence Advisories triggered by the ruling. The Ruling is submitted to the Governance Secretariat for logging and distribution.
10. **Effect of Ruling.** All Coherence Rulings are binding upon the disputing disciplines from the date of issuance. Compliance with a Ruling is not contingent upon the affected discipline's agreement with the outcome. Non-compliance is treated as a coherence failure subject to CAS escalation.
11. **Right of Appeal.** A Coherence Ruling may be formally appealed to the Governance-Level Evaluation Layer (Layer 6) by any directly affected discipline within one governance cycle of the Ruling's issuance. Filing of an appeal does not suspend the operative effect of the Ruling pending resolution of the appeal unless Layer 6 issues an explicit stay.

SECTION 7 — INTERACTION RULES

7.1 Inputs to the CDCL

The CDCL receives inputs from the following sources:

12. **Governance-Discipline Interface Layer (Layer 1):** Structural and procedural directives; notifications of new discipline onboarding; interface protocol updates.

13. **Participating Disciplines:** Coherence Dispute Notices (CDNs); framework submission notifications; assumption declarations; responses to Coherence Advisories.

7.2 Outputs from the CDCL

The CDCL issues outputs to the following recipients:

14. **Participating Disciplines:** Coherence Advisories (via CAS); Coherence Rulings (via adjudication protocol); lexicon and assumption register updates.

15. **Cross-Discipline Synchronization Layer (Layer 3):** Coherence Audit Reports (CARs); advisory logs for cross-cycle continuity tracking; open dispute notifications.

16. **Governance Deliberative Bodies:** Coherence Audit Reports (CARs); escalation notices; formal coherence breach notifications.

7.3 Scope Boundary

△ Critical Boundary Condition

The CDCL does not issue operational instructions to any discipline. Its jurisdiction is strictly limited to the governance of conceptual and structural conditions — definitional standards, framework alignment, and foundational assumptions. Any instruction that crosses the boundary into operational direction is outside the CDCL's authority and must be routed through the appropriate governance layer.

7.4 Interaction Flow Summary

Direction	Counterpart	Nature of Exchange
Inbound	Layer 1 (GDIL)	Structural directives, onboarding notifications, interface protocol updates
Inbound	Disciplines	CDNs, framework submissions, assumption declarations, advisory responses

Direction	Counterpart	Nature of Exchange
Outbound	Disciplines	Coherence Advisories, Rulings, lexicon and CDAR updates
Outbound	Layer 3 (Synchronization)	CARs, advisory logs, open dispute notifications
Outbound	Governance Deliberative Bodies	CARs, escalation notices, coherence breach notifications

SECTION 8 — CADENCE AND REVIEW

Activity	Cadence	Trigger or Condition
Coherence Audit	Every governance cycle	Automatic; no trigger required. CAR produced and submitted at cycle close.
△CS Master Lexicon Review	Biannual (scheduled); rolling (as needed)	Scheduled: biannual full review. Rolling: upon receipt of CDN or introduction of new shared term or construct.
Assumption Register (CDAR) Update	Following each major cross-discipline initiative	Triggered by completion or initiation of any initiative involving two or more disciplines. Liaisons responsible for updates.
CAS Advisory Review	Each governance cycle	Standing item in the coherence audit. All open advisories reviewed; escalation status assessed.
Coherence Adjudication	Within one governance cycle of CDN acceptance	Triggered by valid CDN submission. Panel convened by CCO within five business days of CDN acceptance.

SECTION 9 — ROLES AND ACCOUNTABILITIES

Role	Accountabilities
Chief Coherence Officer (CCO)	Leads all CDCL operations. Convenes and chairs the Coherence Panel for all adjudication proceedings. Signs off on all Coherence Audit Reports (CARs) prior to governance submission. Authorizes updates to the Δ CS Master Lexicon. Escalates to Layer 6 or Layer 7 as required by Section 10. Ensures CDCL operating procedures comply with current governance supermajority directives.
Discipline Coherence Liaisons (one per participating discipline)	Maintain their discipline's entries in the Cross-Discipline Assumption Register (CDAR). Receive, acknowledge, and respond to all Coherence Advisories issued to their discipline. File Coherence Dispute Notices (CDNs) on behalf of their discipline. Submit assumption declarations at the initiation of each shared initiative. Serve as primary point of contact between the CDCL and their discipline.
Governance Secretariat	Routes Coherence Audit Reports (CARs) to all designated governance deliberative bodies. Maintains the official log of all Coherence Rulings, CDNs, and CAS advisories. Records and archives all Coherence Panel proceedings. Manages the formal dispute register.
Coherence Panel Members (convened as required)	Deliberate in good faith on contested coherence questions. Remain bound by CDCL procedural rules during deliberation. Issue a written Coherence Ruling within the required timeframe. Declare conflicts of interest prior to deliberation.

SECTION 10 — ESCALATION PATHWAYS

The following escalation pathways govern situations in which CDCL processes are insufficient to resolve a coherence matter within the standard adjudication framework.

Triggering Condition	Escalation Target	Nature of Escalation
Unresolved Coherence Dispute following Coherence Ruling (i.e., formal appeal filed)	Governance-Level Evaluation Layer (Layer 6)	Full appellate review of Coherence Ruling; Layer 6 may affirm, modify, or vacate. Ruling remains operative pending appeal unless Layer 6 issues an explicit stay.
Systemic coherence breakdown affecting three or more disciplines simultaneously	Governance-Level Invitation/Exclusion Layer (Layer 7)	Structural review of Δ CS framework architecture; assessment of whether discipline configuration or stack architecture requires revision.
Repeated coherence failures by a specific discipline (two or more Critical-tier CAS events within a single governance cycle)	Governance-Discipline Interface Layer (Layer 1 — GDIL)	Interface protocol review for the relevant discipline; assessment of whether the discipline's participation conditions require modification.
CCO determines CDCL operating capacity is insufficient to manage volume of active coherence disputes	Governance Deliberative Bodies (via CAR)	Capacity review; governance deliberative body may authorize CDCL resource expansion or structural adjustment.

Escalation Protocol Note

All escalations initiated by the CDCL are logged by the Governance Secretariat and included in the subsequent Coherence Audit Report. Escalation is not a punitive action; it is a structural mechanism for routing matters beyond the CDCL's resolution authority to the appropriate governance layer.

SECTION 11 — AMENDMENT CONDITIONS

Amendments to any component of the CDCL framework are subject to the conditions specified below. Amendment conditions are designed to ensure that the coherence architecture itself remains stable and is not subject to modification through ordinary operational pressure.

Component	Amendment Authority	Required Threshold
CDCL Operating Procedures (this document)	Governance Deliberative Bodies	Governance supermajority vote. Amendment proposal must be circulated to all disciplines no fewer than two governance cycles before the vote.
△CS Master Lexicon — individual entries	Chief Coherence Officer (CCO)	CCO authorization with formal concurrence from two or more affected disciplines. Disputed entry amendments subject to full adjudication protocol.
Cross-Discipline Assumption Register (CDAR) — individual entries	Discipline Coherence Liaisons (own discipline entries); CCO (cross-discipline entries)	Standard update following initiative completion. Material changes to cross-discipline entries require CCO notification and a five-business-day review window.
Coherence Adjudication Protocol (Section 6)	Governance Deliberative Bodies	Governance supermajority vote with full CDCL review and formal written recommendation from the CCO. No amendment to the Protocol may be made during an active adjudication proceeding.
Coherence Advisory System — tier definitions (Section 4.1)	CCO with Governance Secretariat notification	CCO authorization. Changes to Critical-tier definitions require governance deliberative body notification and a thirty-day review period before taking effect.

REVISION TRACKING & DOCUMENT CONTROL

Version	Date	Revised By	Nature of Change
1.0	July 2026	CCO / Governance Secretariat	Initial issue. Full CDCL operating charter established.
1.x	[Future]	[Amending authority per §11]	Reserved for future revisions. All amendments must be logged here with nature-of-change description before the revised document is circulated.

Revision Guidance: All proposed amendments must reference the specific section, component, and amendment condition (Section 11) under which the change is authorized. Revised versions of this document are assigned sequential version numbers (1.1, 1.2, etc.) for minor amendments; a new major version number (2.0, etc.) for structural or supermajority-authorized revisions. Superseded versions are archived by the Governance Secretariat and remain accessible to all participating disciplines.

Distribution: This document is classified **Governance Framework — Restricted**.

Distribution is limited to: (a) CCO and CDCL staff; (b) Discipline Coherence Liaisons; (c) Governance Secretariat; (d) designated members of governance deliberative bodies. External distribution requires CCO authorization.

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